This road was being constructed more or less on the same alignment as that of an earlier road that had been abandoned many years ago. I sought the help of the defence minister, A.K. Antony, and then Air Chief Marshal Naik to expedite the repairs and lengthening of the runway of Vijaynagar airfield. Consequent to that, airlifting of heavy earthmoving machinery to Vijaynagar has already been accomplished by two or three MI 26 sorties so that work on the road could commence from that end as well. I had promised the people of Vijaynagar that I would lead the first convoy when this road project was completed. Though I couldn't keep my promise, I was delighted to learn that from early May 2011, jeeps and light trucks commenced moving on this road. At a later stage it could be converted to a single-lane black-top road except probably the stretch that goes through the famous forest reserve. As of April 2012, the road has been made motorable except during the monsoon period. Rohini and I flew in by helicopter on 18 November, preceded by Air Marshal S. Varthaman, C-in-C of Eastern Air Command; it was the first landing by an AN32 airforce transport aircraft in the newly repaired and upgraded airfield at Vijaynagar. The scenic beauty, wildlife, flora and fauna of the Namdapha national park makes it a tourist's paradise, and hopefully it would soon begin to figure in the tourism map of the world. This would totally transform the living conditions of the people and the economy of this neglected area.